

HEADLINE



Since 1956

NEWSLETTER OF THE ADVERTISING CLUB, MADRAS - DECEMBER '25

Journalists
who sleep
with a
clear
conscience.

Journalists
with
breaking
news,
not
broken
news.

Journalists
who
frequently
question
answers.

News
that
can't be
bot.



InsightView
Series

Understanding the Global Desi
Diaspora Market

DINAMALAR 
Presents

MADDYS 2025
43rd MADRAS ADVERTISING CLUB AWARDS

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THE HINDU

New Leadership
Announcement

Introducing the
2025-2026
ECM / Office Bearers

Since 1878

Written by
JOURNALISTS

Print | Web | App



The Legend who rewrote
the language of Indian Advertising.

Surej Salim Elected President of The Advertising Club Madras for 2025–2026

The Advertising Club Madras has announced the election of Mr. Surej Salim, Co-Founder & COO of Digitally Inspired Media, as its 46th President for the year 2025–2026. The announcement was made at the Club's Annual General Meeting held on Friday, 24th October 2025.

With nearly two decades of experience in the advertising and marketing fraternity, Mr. Surej Salim brings a strong commitment to creativity, collaboration, and community-building. Having previously served as Secretary of the Club, he steps into this leadership role with a clear vision to strengthen the advertising ecosystem, foster industry connections, and elevate creative excellence.

The meeting began with a moment of silence in honour of Mr. Piyush Pandey,

one of India's most iconic advertising leaders. A tribute speech followed, highlighting his unparalleled contributions to the creative industry. Black ribbons were distributed to members as a mark of respect and remembrance.

Speaking on his appointment, Mr. Surej Salim said:

"It's an honour to lead a legacy institution like the Advertising Club of Madras, which has been the heartbeat of the advertising and marketing community for nearly seven decades. My vision is to strengthen our community, celebrate creativity, and create more opportunities for learning and collaboration. With the collective energy of our members and the dynamic new committee, I'm confident we can make this a truly inspiring year for the Club."



Ms. Kavitha Srinivasan, elected as Secretary

"I am delighted to be elected as Secretary of the Advertising Club of Madras. With a talented team and enthusiastic members, we are poised to make a significant impact in the industry. I look forward to working collaboratively to deliver engaging events, insightful discussions, and valuable networking opportunities."

With its newly elected Executive Committee, The Advertising Club Madras looks ahead to a year dedicated to strengthening the advertising community, building deeper industry relationships, and championing creative excellence.

**ADVERTISING CLUB MADRAS
IT'S YOUR CLUB.
BUT WHERE IS YOUR
MEMBERSHIP?**

As you know, the Ad club is going all-out to intensify its efforts to bring the advertising fraternity together more often and more meaningfully. However, our activities cannot materialise on good wishes alone. We need your support, Your membership renewals, and your active participation. You are urged to make it happen.

For New Membership/Renewal

Contact Ms. Vaishnavi : +91 82487 17152 Visit-www.adclubmadras.com



Office Bearers and Executive Committee Members (2025–2026)

Name	Designation	Organization
Mr. Surej Salim	President	Digitally Inspired Media
Mr. Umanath V	Vice President	MediaNews4U.com
Ms. Kavitha Srinivasan	Secretary	Coeus Communications India LLP
Mr. Stalin Periasamy	Joint Secretary	Presto Advertising
Mr. Murugan K	Treasurer	Jaya TV
Mr. S Balasubramanian	Immediate Past President	Dinamalar
Mr. Chockalingam S	Executive Committee Member	OPN Advertising Pvt. Ltd.
Mr. L.V. Navaneeth	Executive Committee Member	The Hindu Group
Mr. John Justin	Executive Committee Member	The Hindu Group
Mr. Ramkumar Singaram	Executive Committee Member	Catalyst Public Relations Pvt. Ltd.
Mr. M. Ramalingam	Executive Committee Member	Ontwikkel Advertising Pvt. Ltd.
Mr. Siluvai Amalan	Executive Committee Member	Mr. A Brand Works
Mr. N. Upendran	Executive Committee Member	Ayatiworks Technologies LLP
Mr. Rakesh	Executive Committee Member	Deepsense Digital Solutions Pvt Ltd.
Mr. Ravindran Solomon	Executive Committee Member	Soloverse
Ms. Baatul Turab	Executive Committee Member	The Raven Claw

The Past Presidents, Mr. Karthic Moorthy (Elegant Publicities), Mr. Anbuezhian K, Mr. M. M. Charly, Mr. P. Shree Prakash (Feswa), and Mr. Paul Anthony (Luminas India Associates) are Co-opted Members of the committee.

Mr. V. Saravanaa (PSG Institutions) and Ms. Arabbi Athreya (Happy Unicorn) has been newly appointed as Co-opted Member.



An ongoing initiative to meet our members and get valuable feedback on the club's activities. To know more details,

PLEASE CONTACT
044-42694778 / 8248717152

We would like you to contribute to our newsletter by submitting articles, book reviews, and job openings. We can also invite agencies, individuals to share/showcase their work.

Please mail us to headline@adclubmadras.com

MADDYS

2025

A Grand Celebration of Creative, Media, Digital, Design & Strategy Excellence

The Advertising Club Madras hosted the 43rd edition of MADDYS on 20th September 2025, bringing together top creative, media, digital, design, and advertising talent. This year's theme, "AI vs AI – Awesome Ideas vs Awesome Ideas," celebrated the dynamic interplay between artificial intelligence and human imagination.

The event reaffirmed its position as one of the region's most prestigious advertising awards.

Event Highlights

- Strong Participation: 929 entries across 155 categories.
- Wider Reach: Submissions from 106+ agencies and clients across India and Nepal.
- Robust Judging: 340 entries shortlisted through a comprehensive multi-level evaluation process.
- Thought Leadership Panel: "Awesome Ideas in the Age of AI," featuring Senthil Kumar, Chocka, Lakshmipathy Bhat, Roshni Chandran, and Shiv Parameswaran, moderated by Gokul Krishnamoorthy.
- Grand Evening: Awards ceremony, networking, cocktails, dinner, and entertainment.

Judging Process

MADDYS 2025 upheld its commitment to fairness and transparency with an enhanced evaluation framework. Each entry was independently assessed on Strategy & Insights, Originality & Creativity, and Execution & Impact using a structured 30-point scale. Shortlisted work was further reviewed through collective jury deliberations to arrive at the final winners.

The process was overseen by 8 Jury Chairs and 27 industry experts, with Mr. Gokul Krishnamoorthy serving as Honorary Jury Convenor and Process Auditor.

This year concluded with 184 awards, including: 4 Grand Prix, 31 Gold, 61 Silver, 76 Bronze, and 12 special honours.

Theme of the Year: "AI vs AI – Awesome Ideas vs Awesome Ideas"

The theme showcased how creativity continues to thrive in a world shaped by artificial intelligence—reinforcing that human ideas remain at the heart of powerful storytelling.

DINAMALAR 75
Presents

MADDYS 2025
43rd MADRAS ADVERTISING CLUB AWARDS

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INDIA'S FAVOURITE SPRING MATTRESS

Winners at a Glance

Creative MADDYS

- Agency of the Year - Mind Your Language!
- Client of the Year - Way2News

Digital MADDYS

- Agency of the Year - Advertout Ventures
- Client of the Year - ITC Classmate

Media MADDYS

- Agency of the Year - The Sight
- Client of the Year - Lingo India Private Limited

Film & Audio Craft MADDYS

- Producer of the Year - Kadhai Films

Design & Print Craft MADDYS

- Agency of the Year - be positive 24 Innovation Design Private Limited
- Art Directors of the Year - Rakesh Gandla & Velu Radhakrishnan
- Copywriter of the Year - Abhishek D Shah

Regional Pride (Tamil) MADDYS

- Agency of the Year - Mind Your Language!
- Client of the Year - Way2News

Acknowledgments

The Advertising Club Madras extends sincere thanks to all sponsors and partners whose support made MADDYS 2025 a grand success.

Sponsors: Dinamalar (Title Sponsor), Peps (Powered By Sponsor), Vikatan (Film & Audio Craft Category Sponsor), The Hindu (Media Partner), Luminous India (Outdoor Partner), Jaya TV (Television Partner), Deepsense Digital Solutions (Technology Partner), Elevate Productions (Reels Partner), and Cavinkare, Aachi Masala & YOUNEEK (Gift Partners).

Community Partners: Pepper Awards, Adgully, Mediabrief, The Advertising Club, The Advertising Club Bangalore, Advertising Club Trivandrum, and The Advertising Club Coimbatore. Their support, along with the tireless contributions of the Executive Committee, Jury Members, and Volunteers, ensured a seamless and memorable event.

Creative MADDYS -
Agency of the Year - Mind Your Language!



Design & Print Craft MADDYS -
Agency of the Year - be positive 24 Innovation



Leadership Message

Mr. S. Balasubramanian, President, Advertising Club Madras, highlighted the exceptional participation this year and the Club's progress toward becoming an international platform. He emphasized the strengthened judging process, the Club's 68-year legacy, and the numerous initiatives undertaken in the past two years — all contributing to this celebration of “Awesome Ideas vs Awesome Ideas.”



Mr. Surej Salim, Secretary, Advertising Club Madras, congratulated all winners and thanked the Executive Committee, Subcommittees, office staff, sponsors, and partners for making the event a success. He expressed gratitude to all participants and looked forward to an even more exciting MADDYS 2026.

When the obvious becomes rare, it must be said out loud.

Created with Talented, The Hindu 'Written by Journalists' calls out a culture of speed over substance.

The Hindu has unveiled its new campaign Written by Journalists, created in collaboration with Talented. The campaign reaffirms the publication's 147-year-old legacy of journalism built on rigour, responsibility, and respect for the reader, by stating what should have been obvious all along.

At a time when misinformation spreads faster than facts, and sensationalism often overshadows substance, The Hindu stands apart for its editorial integrity, where every word is reported, reviewed, and published by its journalists. The campaign captures this with quiet confidence.

Since 1878, The Hindu has stood for words that matter. Written by Journalists is a reminder that even after 147 years, fact-checking, thoughtful editing, and public accountability are not relics of the past but everyday practice.

LV Navaneeth, Chief Executive Officer of The Hindu Group said, "Our readers trust us to separate fact from noise. We are in an age where content is everywhere, but credibility is rare, being 'Written by Journalists' is not a campaign name but it's our truth."

Launched with 'Find The Story' print ad and subsequent ad films titled 'Who writes the news you hear?' and 'Who writes the news you read?' Talented and The Hindu's assertive messaging for the campaign reiterates the newspaper's accuracy over attention, depth over speed, and accountability over applause. Taking the message beyond print and digital, the campaign also features a series of bold one-liners displayed on OOH sites across the country.



**Journalists chasing the truth,
not the algorithm.**



**Journalists who
stand with truth,
not convenience.**



**Journalists with
breaking news, not
broken news.**



**Journalists who sleep with
a clear conscience.**



PG Aditiya, Co-founder and CCO, Talented, said “When a publication doesn’t believe it has quality readers, it feels no pressure to hire quality writers. That’s not the case with The Hindu. Its readers are discerning, and the brand shows them respect across every format - newspaper, app, or podcast, by doubling down on what great journalism should read, sound, and feel like. Much like advertising, journalism is not just a profession, it’s a passion. And while many have tarnished it, The Hindu continues to protect it.”

*Everyone has a platform.
Few have a newsroom.*

Adclub Madras Student Chapter Expert Session at MEPCO

Opening Doors to the World of Advertising

The Adclub Madras Student Chapter at MEPCO School of Management Studies, Sivakasi continued its momentum with an insightful expert session for the first-year MBA students on 15th November 2025. The session, titled *"Introduction to the World of Advertising,"* was facilitated by Mr. K. Anbuezhian, Former President of the Advertising Club Madras, and Mr. Ravindran Solomon, Executive Committee Member.

The session offered students a comprehensive view of the evolving advertising landscape.

Mr. Anbuezhian highlighted how advertising today blends art, science, data, and storytelling to engage modern consumers across both traditional and digital platforms. He stressed the rising influence of word-of-mouth communication and user-generated content, reminding students that authentic consumer advocacy often surpasses the impact of paid promotions.



Building on this foundation, Mr. Ravindran Solomon delivered an engaging talk on the idea-driven nature of creativity in advertising. He emphasized the importance of understanding people—their beliefs, behaviours, and culture—before crafting communication. Through examples from brands like Volvo, Castrol, Nike, Tanishq, and Apple, he illustrated how originality, clarity, and insight shape powerful campaigns. His session encouraged students to embrace lateral thinking, emotional storytelling, humour, and visual expression as essential creative tools.

The expert session left participants inspired to think more creatively and explore the dynamic world of communication with curiosity and confidence. Through initiatives like this, the Adclub Madras Student Chapter continues to nurture the next generation of advertising and media professionals, strengthening the bridge between academia and industry.





PUB Quiz

A Night of Fun & Fierce Competition

The Adclub Madras PUB Quiz was held on Wednesday, 19th November at Unwind Pub, Grand Continent Premiere, T. Nagar. The evening began with registrations and hi-tea at 5:30 PM, followed by an engaging quiz session from 6:00 PM to 7:30 PM. Led by quiz masters Ms. Batul Turab, Quiz Sub-Committee Chair, and Mr. Siluvai Amalan, Executive Committee Member, the event brought together six enthusiastic teams for a spirited battle of wit and knowledge.

The quiz featured a vibrant mix of rounds including Alcoholia, Namma Chennai, Connections, and Advertising, keeping participants and the audience fully immersed throughout. The atmosphere remained lively, with strong camaraderie and competitive energy fuelling every round.

Winners of the Evening

- 1st Prize – ₹5,000: Mr. Jayakanthan & Mr. Gopal (TCS/MMS)
- 2nd Prize – ₹3,000: Mr. Cherian Varghese & Mr. Vipin Austin (Indian Oil Corporation Ltd)
- 3rd Prize – ₹2,000: Mr. Nandhakumar & Mr. Saisiddharth (Dreamworx)

PUB QUIZ

Congratulations



1st Prize - Mr. Jayakanthan & Mr. Gopal (TCS/MMS)



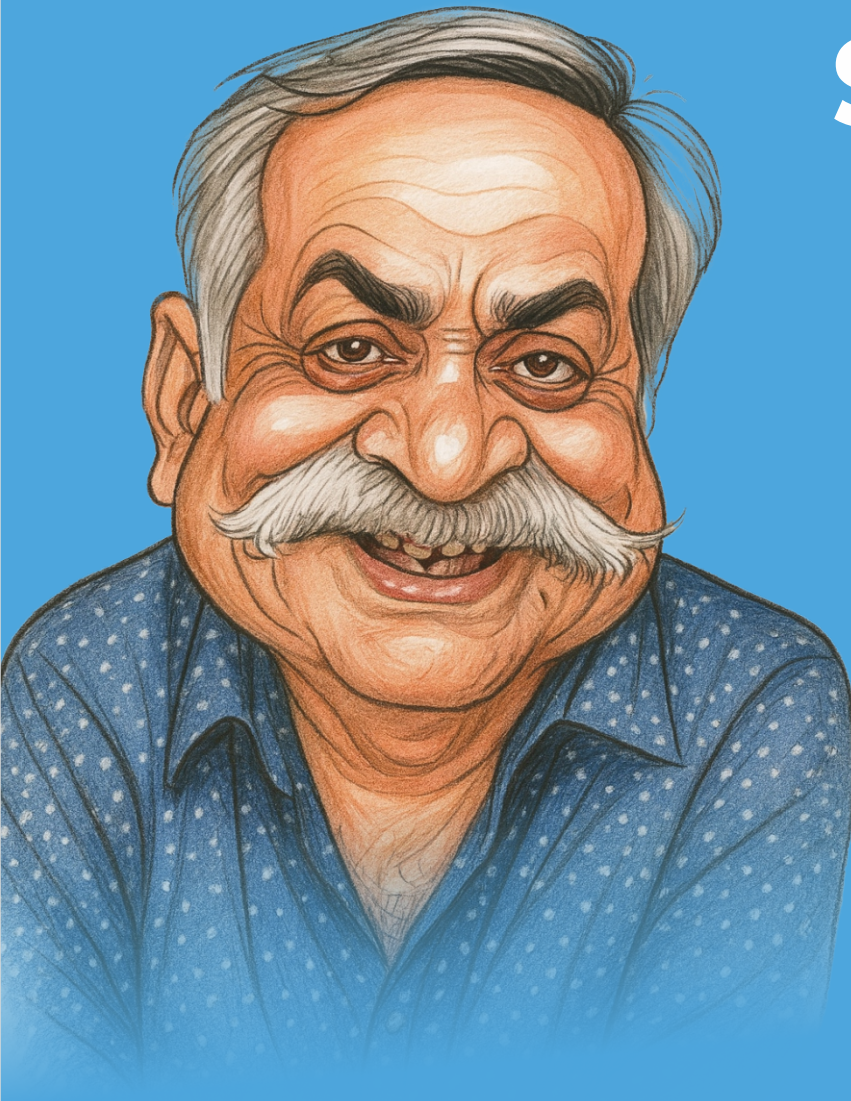
2nd Prize - Mr. Cherian Varghese & Vipin Austin (IOCL)



3rd Prize - Mr. Nandhakumar & Mr. Saisiddharth (Dreamworx)

Certificates were awarded to all participants and winners in appreciation of their enthusiastic involvement. Adclub Madras extends sincere thanks to the quiz masters for delivering a dynamic and well-structured session, to all participants and audience members for their spirited engagement, and to Emperor Lifts & Ladoos for their generous sponsorship support.

The STORYTELLER of the STREETS



Piyush Pandey was fondly called the storyteller of the streets: the man who made advertising deeply human, the man who transformed the stories of ordinary lives into extraordinary campaigns.

Piyush had remarked once, “The best ideas come from the street, from life, from listening,”—a mantra which delivered impeccable ads that we still resonate with.

Roots and Influences

- Born into a middle-class family in Jaipur, he grew up with seven sisters and a younger brother.
- His father was a connoisseur of theatre and literature.
- His father’s love for literature and his mother’s humour-laden stories influenced him from a very young age.

A Humble Beginning, A Grand Journey

- Before he moved billions of hearts with his ads, he had a humble beginning as a tea taster and had even worked in the construction field.
- A passionate cricketer from his college days, he played for Rajasthan in the Ranji Trophy.
- He led his Delhi University team to victory in the Rohinton Baria Trophy.

Connecting with People through Ads was his Calling

- Ultimately found his calling when he joined Ogilvy in 1982, emerging as the Executive Chairman of Ogilvy India.
- Served as the global creative chief of Ogilvy from his Mumbai office.
- He took on the position of Creative Advisor of Ogilvy India in 2024 to continue mentoring and moulding the next generation of Indian creatives until his last breath.

His creativity transcended advertising.

- Apart from ads, Piyush was also into many other creative pursuits.
- Penned the lyrics for the popular patriotic song 'Mile Sur Mera Tumhara' (1988) in 14 different languages.
- Co-Wrote the screenplay for the movie Bhopal Express (1999).
- Played a striking cameo as the Cabinet Secretary of India in the movie 'Madras Café' (2013).

The Pandey Effect

- Decades later, his works remain glued to our collective consciousness—an impeccable bond worthy of the Fevikwik ads he created.
- Out of all the ads, it was the **Pulse Polio campaign** that Piyush did with Amitabh Bachchan that gave him a sense of fulfilment.
- He worked on the campaign for a decade, after which India became polio-free in 2014.

A few of his recognitions and honours

- The first advertising professional to receive the Padma Shri Award (2016).
- First Asian to receive the Lion of St Mark, the highest honour at the Cannes Lions International Festival of Creativity.
- The 1st Asian to head the Cannes jury as early as in 2004.
- In 2024, the London International Awards honoured Piyush with the LIA Legend Award, acknowledging his contributions to the advertising industry.

Words That Shaped Generations

- He authored the books—'Pandeymonium' (2015) and 'Open House With Piyush Pandey' (2022)—that dive into the behind-the-scenes stories of his ad campaigns.
- The 1st chapter of his book '**Pandeymonium**' starts with the line "Everyone and Everything Around You is a Teacher." It reflects how he intricately wove what he learnt—by actively listening and keenly observing the social setting—into his stories and ingenious ads.

His legacy lives on

- Just like his Asian Paints ad's tagline, "Har Ghar Kuch Kehta Hai" (Every house has something to say), his every ad had a story that played with our heartstrings.
- The stories did not stem from nowhere—it was from his own experiences that he built the script of ads like the Fevicol Bus Ad (2002) that bagged a Silver Lion at Cannes and the Ponds ad (2002) with the catchy tagline 'Googly Woogly Woosh'.
- Like the sofa that endures through the years in his iconic ad '1959 A Love Story', his stories will transcend generations and live on as the pinnacle of creativity and audience appeal.



**Piyush, you will be sorely missed
and forever remembered.**

When Two Neighbours Share a Doorplate: Reading the Omnicom IPG Merger



A Rivalry That Turned Into a Union

For decades, Omnicom and IPG lived as neighbours with the same ambitions. They pitched to the same clients, built parallel empires and spent years trying to outthink each other across awards, regions and categories.

In August 2025, Omnicom announced it would acquire IPG in a stock-for-stock deal valued at \$13 billion. The merger closed at the end of the year, and the shifting markets brought the value closer to \$9 billion. Yet it still created the world's largest advertising and marketing holding company by revenue, overtaking Publicis and WPP and altering the competitive landscape.

One Roof, One Brain

This is more than a transaction. It marks the moment two long-time competitors recognised that the battleground is now shaped by data, technology and new kinds of rivals.

Inside the enlarged Omnicom house, the focus is to bring everything together under one system. By uniting Omnicom's Omni data and AI platform with IPG's Acxiom and CRM strengths, the group plans to build a single intelligence engine that learns across markets, briefs and channels.

Efficiency sits alongside intelligence, with cost synergy targets in the high hundreds of millions of US dollars each year and more than 4,000 overlapping roles set for removal.

Redesigning the House

The urgency comes from new competition. Omnicom and IPG are no longer up against only Publicis or WPP but also Amazon, Google, Accenture and Deloitte, each armed with AI-heavy, cloud-ready and commerce-driven offerings.

Inside the new structure, BBDO, TBWA and McCann continue as the main creative networks, while agencies under banners such as DDB, FCB and MullenLowe are brought together under one combined system.

The Ripple Effect Across Markets

The impact reaches far beyond New York. In markets such as India, the merged setup could offer smoother cross-market access if navigated carefully. Two giants now share a doorplate, and the neighbourhood must decide how to evolve, compete or redefine itself.

THE GLOBAL DESI DIASPORA MARKET: UNDERSTANDING AND ENGAGING 40+ MILLION NRIs AND GLOBAL DESIS

Dr. Tausif Malik

Publisher & Editor of The Desi Buzz, The MAD BUZZ
The Dubai Buzz, GCC Startup News
Startup Berita & RiseBack & Founder of RiseBack.org



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InsightView Series

The 31st session of the InsightView Series featured an enlightening talk by Dr. Tausif Malik, Publisher & Editor of The Desi Buzz, The MAD BUZZ, The Dubai Buzz, GCC Startup News, Startup Berita, and RiseBack, and Founder of RiseBack.org. A social entrepreneur, media innovator, and educator, Dr. Malik brought deep expertise and a global perspective to the discussion.

Held on Friday, 28th November from 4 PM to 5 PM via Zoom, the session focused on the theme: “The Global Desi Diaspora Market: Understanding and Engaging 40+ Million NRIs and Global Desis.”

This edition of the series placed special emphasis on the UAE diaspora, exploring how the region's large and

influential Indian community is shaping cultural trends, media consumption, entrepreneurship, and market opportunities.

Dr. Malik highlighted the rapidly expanding NRI and Global Desi ecosystem—particularly in the UAE, examining their cultural influence, economic power, and evolving consumer behaviour. He discussed how brands can meaningfully connect with this audience by leveraging cultural identity, digital habits, and diaspora-led innovation. The session also covered media patterns, entrepreneurial growth, and emerging markets driven by global Indian populations.

The session provided attendees with a deeper understanding of the Global Desi ecosystem—with a focused lens on the UAE—and the strategic potential it holds for marketers, media professionals, and communication specialists.